AI is everywhere. In my day job, I'm expected to adopt it, experiment with it, and find ways to innovate with it. However, adopting AI does not mean blindly accepting what it produces. We are expected to function as the expert; to challenge, validate, refine, and ultimately take responsibility for the output.

I encourage you to approach AI in the same way. Just as you would with any other source that informs your opinions and perspectives, AI is **one source of information**, even when it draws from many other sources. It can help you brainstorm, research, organize your thoughts, or challenge your thinking, but it should not replace your judgment.

As you begin working through the coursework and assignments, please keep in mind that the work you submit should be your own. Ultimately, it is you who will be graded. If you choose to use AI, I encourage you to use it thoughtfully and critically. Below are a few questions I encourage you to ask yourself when reviewing outputs that will inform your submitted work. These are also similar to the questions I will be asking when I evaluate your submissions.

1. Review, Review, Review

Anything you submit, you should read as I will too. Before submitting an assignment or discussion, ask yourself:

- Do I understand the requirements and how I will be graded? (**before using AI**)
- Does this address what the assignment is actually asking me to focus on? (**when reviewing AI output**)
- Does it reflect my own perspective, experiences, and interests? (**when reviewing AI output**)
- Does it sound like something I would actually say? (**when reviewing AI output**)
- Have I incorporated any feedback I have previously received? (**when reviewing AI output**)
- If I used AI, did I challenge and refine its output rather than simply accept it? (**when reviewing AI output**)

Each assignment will include an overview and rubric, and your classmates will have access to the same information. If you are using AI to help you develop your work, your classmates may be doing the same. As a result, simply accepting the first output can lead to remarkably similar submissions (i.e., similar companies, initiatives, opportunities, and even language).

Take the time to make the work **yours**.

You all bring different professional experiences, backgrounds, and interests to this course. I expect those differences to come through in your work. Your unique perspective is one of the things that can make your contribution more valuable than a generic, technically correct response.

2. Check Your Sources

This is perhaps the easiest next step in implementing point number 1. It is also one of the most commonly overlooked steps.

All assignments this term are expected to include the sources you used. If you use AI to help identify sources, you may be tempted to copy and paste the sources it provides directly into your assignment. **Please don't.** Before citing a source, click through and confirm for yourself:

- Is the link active?
- Does the source actually support the claim I am making?
- Is it directly relevant to the topic?
- Is there a more authoritative or specific source available?
- Am I citing the original source, rather than an article that simply references it?

These checks should not add much time to your work, but they can make a significant difference in its quality and credibility.

3. Tell Me How You Used AI

Although it may seem counterintuitive, I invite you to identify the AI tools you use in your work (it is one of your sources after all). If you use ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or another tool, consider including the tool and, where relevant, the model, in your documentation of sources.

My goal is not to discourage you from using AI. **I want you to learn how to use it effectively**.

As I mentioned, I use AI in my work constantly and in my experience the workforce will increasingly expect you to work *with* AI while still exercising your own expertise and judgment. Use this course as an opportunity to practice and develop that skill. Use AI to expand your thinking, challenge your assumptions, and improve your work but remember that **you are the one responsible for what you ultimately submit.**